Darkstar / Overlord GCI Comms Flow

vSFG7 SkyEye · AI AWACS on SRS · Black Sea Day / Night: **Darkstar 264.000 AM** (Hornet COMM 1 CH 5) · Syria / Foothold: **Overlord 266.000 AM** · SkyEye f0df333, 21 Oct 2026

Before you call	Detail
Your DCS name	Put the squadron callsign in it: **Raider 302 | Jedi**, **Venom 212 | Dabs** (it may sit anywhere, e.g. "vSFG-7 | Raider 302 | Jedi"). Without Raider / Venom NNN the GCI cannot find you on scope.
Your SRS name	The same as your DCS name, or threat and merged calls will not reach you.
Every call	"**Darkstar**" (or "Overlord", or "Anyface"), **your callsign**, the request: "Darkstar, Raider 3-0-2, picture."
Numbers	Bearings three digits, one at a time ("zero six five"); ranges and altitudes as normal numbers ("twenty-five", "twelve thousand"). Plain three, five, nine - not tree, fife, niner.

1. The flow, in order

Step	Pilot (SRS)	Darkstar
Command 282.000	"Command, Raider 302, checking in." - tasking, Hitman, tankers as usual	"... proceed mission." (a fence in on Command adds "Darkstar is up on two six four point zero for picture.")
Check in 264.000	"Darkstar, Raider 302, **checking in**."	"RAIDER 3 0 2, DARKSTAR, **radar contact**."
Radio check	"Darkstar, Raider 302, **radio check**." (or comm check)	"RAIDER 3 0 2, DARKSTAR, **good copy**." / "... **5 by 5**." Off scope: "..., but I don't see you on scope."
Fence in	"Darkstar, Raider 302, **fence in**."	"RAIDER 3 0 2, DARKSTAR, **copy fence in, picture follows**." - then the picture
Alpha check	"Darkstar, Raider 302, **alpha check**."	"..., contact, alpha check bullseye 010/48" (your position, a check on the INS)
Picture	"Darkstar, Raider 302, **picture**."	"Darkstar, 2 groups. Group bullseye 010/48, 25000, track southwest, hostile, 2 contacts, Flanker. Group ..." (the top 3 groups)
Bogey dope	"..., **bogey dope**." · "..., any **fast movers**?" (jets only) · "..., **slow movers**." (helicopters only)	"Raider 3 0 2, group BRAA 045/32, 25000, hot, hostile, Flanker" (the nearest threat to you)
Declare	"..., **declare** bullseye one two four, fifty-one, seven thousand."	That group: hostile / friendly / furball / clean
Snaplock (BVR, quick)	"..., **snaplock** one two five, ten, eight thousand."	"threat BRAA 125/10, 8000, hot, hostile, ..."
Spiked / strobe	"..., **spiked** zero eight zero." (or strobe)	"spike range 35, 16000, flank northeast, hostile" - or "clean 080"
Vector	"..., **vector to tanker**." (or to bullseye)	The nearest tanker for your aircraft: bearing, range, altitude
Splash	"Darkstar, Raider 302, **splash one**."	"RAIDER 3 0 2, DARKSTAR, **copy splash one**."
Fence out	"Darkstar, Raider 302, **fence out**."	"RAIDER 3 0 2, DARKSTAR, **copy fence out**."
Check out	"Darkstar, Raider 302, **checking out**."	"RAIDER 3 0 2, DARKSTAR, **copy, good day**." Then Command: RTB, Marshal / tower.

Fence checks go to Darkstar now (and still work on Command). Overlord on Foothold says the same with its own name and "two six six point zero". The GCI is the air picture only: tasking, tankers, Hitman and RTB stay with Command.

2. What Darkstar says without being asked (tuned to 264 only)

Call	When
Picture	Every 5 minutes while anyone is on frequency, if the picture changed.
Threat	A hostile within 25 nm of you (further for long-range fighters); repeats every 3 minutes while it stays a threat. BRAA when it is about you alone, bullseye when it is about several.
Merged	A hostile jet inside 3 nm of you.
Faded	A hostile near you has been off the scope 30 seconds. **Not a kill** - DCS can hide live aircraft.
Sunrise	Darkstar coming online. Mid-mission it means the GCI just restarted (usually an Update).

3. Rules and tips

Item	Detail
Quiet in recoveries	No threat calls to you, and the automatic picture waits, while you are within 12 nm of the carrier below 10,000 ft or within 10 nm of a field below 4,000 ft. Anything you ask is still answered.
What Darkstar sees	Only what the mission's AWACS could see: the E-3 out to about 217 nm, the E-2 about 200 nm, and not below its radar horizon - a jet on the deck far out is invisible until it climbs or closes. A bandit that drops out of coverage is called **faded**.
Off station	No AWACS airborne (not up yet, or shot down): "All players, Darkstar, off station." Picture, bogey dope and declare get "off station, no picture"; radio check, fence and check in / out still work. "On station" when it is back up.
On the ramp	You may not be on scope until airborne - a radio check says so.
Speak	Think, then key: steady pace, slight pause between numbers. Misspoke? Release and start again.
No answer?	Wait 3-4 s, repeat once. Check 264.000 / 266.000 **AM** and that you opened with "Darkstar". Report callsign, frequency and time on Discord.